

GLORIA CHEN

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EDUCATION

University of Melbourne Bachelor of Commerce. Major in Economics and Finance WAM:91.381	2019 - 2021
University of Melbourne Bachelor of Commerce (Honours) in Economics Advisor: Dr Siqi Pan & Dr Alexandra de Gendre WAM: 92.875 (Awarded the FBE Honours Medal)	2022
University of Melbourne Master of Commerce (Economics) Advisor: Dr. Siqi Pan & Prof. Tom Wilkenning & Dr. Georgy Artemov WAM: 91.143	2023 - 2024
University of Melbourne Ph.D in Economics Advisor: Dr. Siqi Pan & Prof. Tom Wilkenning & Dr. Georgy Artemov	2025 - Present

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Microeconomics Theory
- Experimental and Behavioural Economics

WORK IN PROGRESS

Information Provision in School Choice: A Theoretical Perspective With Dr. Georgy Artemov	2024-Present
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Students from low-socioeconomic (low-SES) backgrounds often face substantial information frictions in school choice. This paper examines the welfare implications of two types of information interventions—providing students with common information (CI) and group-specific information (GI)—in a many-to-one matching model with a continuum of students and a finite set of schools. We show that while CI and GI perform similarly when adopted on a small scale, GI strictly outperforms CI when the information uptake is high. At scale, CI generates congestion externalities that reduce the benefit to informed low-SES students and hurt both high-SES and uninformed low-SES students. GI eliminates this congestion. These findings also hold when the school district implements affirmative action policies. The policy implication is that districts should prioritise information interventions that promote heterogeneity in student preferences.

Signalling in Two-Sided Matching Markets With Dr. Siqi Pan	2024-Present
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In many real-life matching markets, such as residency matches and job applications, employers often send signals of interest to candidates, and these signals frequently influence outcomes. Yet, under the deferred acceptance mechanism, standard matching theory predicts that simply telling a candidate they are favoured should not change how they submit their preferences, since truth-telling is always a weakly dominant strategy. To address this conflict between theory and observation, we develop a behavioural model in which candidates gain additional utility from receiving a positive signal. This framework explains why candidates may respond to signals and how employers can use signalling as a strategic tool to alter candidates' preference submissions in their favour, thereby improving their own allocation outcomes. We complement the model with a laboratory experiment designed to test how candidates respond to signals and how employers choose their signalling strategies.

Closing the Gap: The Role of University Financial Aid Information on Students' Education Decisions With Dr. Alexandra de Gendre and Dr. Siqi Pan	2022-Present
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- Designed a "Financial Aid Calculator" to provide tailored information to high school students in Victoria.
- Demonstrated the lack of college aid information among rural Australian youth.
- Showed that the information treatment effectively adjusted students' beliefs about aid accessibility, university affordability, and their tendency to pursue higher education.

- This thesis was awarded first place in the Deakin Essay Competition (2022) and received the highest score in the Economics Honours cohort.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Market Design for Land Trade: Evidence from Uganda

2023-Present

For Prof. Tom Wilkening, A/Prof. Jonathan de Quidt, A/Prof. Gharad Bryan

- Processed and analysed field data using R.
- Developed matching algorithms to link farmers with available land and identify potential trade opportunities.
- Contributed to the design of survey instruments for field experiments.

ACHIEVEMENTS

Thesis Awards

- First Place — Deakin Essay Competition (Honours and Master Thesis) – 2022
- Jean Polglaze Memorial Prize (Honours Research Essay) – 2022
Awarded for best Economics Honours thesis.

Scholarships

- Australian Government Research Training Program Scholarship (Stipend) – 2025
- Research Training Program Scholarship (Fee offset) – 2025
- Helen Macpherson Smith Scholarship (Humanities and Social Science) – 2025
Awarded to the top-ranked female candidate in Humanities and Social Sciences, based on highest overall score, academic excellence, and research potential.
- Business and Economics Doctoral Program Scholarship – 2023
- Life Course Centre Pathways Scholarship – 2022
- Commerce Achievement Scholarship – 2019

Academic Prizes

- William Noall & Son Prize (Faculty of Business and Economics) – 2022
Awarded to top-achieving final-year Bachelor of Commerce Honours student.
- Economics Honours Prize (Department of Economics) – 2022
Awarded to top-performing student in Economics Honours program.
- Deputy Dean's Award – 2020

Coursework Distinctions

- Eric J. Ingram Prize (Macroeconomics) – 2023
- First Place — Microeconometrics (ECOM40001, Honours) – 2022
- First Place — Experimental Economics (ECON40020, Honours) – 2022
- Department of Economics Prize — Advanced Microeconomics – 2022
- Jean Polglaze Memorial Prize — Time Series Analysis and Forecasting – 2021
- Dean's Honour List — First Year (2019), Second Year (2020), Third Year (2021)

TEACHING

- Advanced Microeconomics (ECON40001): Honours core microeconomics
- Microeconomics (ECON30010): Final-year core subject
- Behavioural Economics (ECON30019): Administrative Tutor (2023)
- Econometrics I (ECOM20001): Core subject for second-year undergraduates
- Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON20002): Second-year core subject
- Microeconomics II (ECON90045): Master's level subject
- Investment (FNCE30001): Final-year finance core subject

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Software: R, Python, oTree, Stata, MATLAB, Mathematica, EViews, QGIS

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)

Citizenship: Australian